""Polarization and inequality are mutually reinforcing — rising income inequality drives political polarization, which in turn blocks the redistributive policies that might reduce inequality." — Nolan McCarty, Polarization: What Everyone Needs to Know, 2019

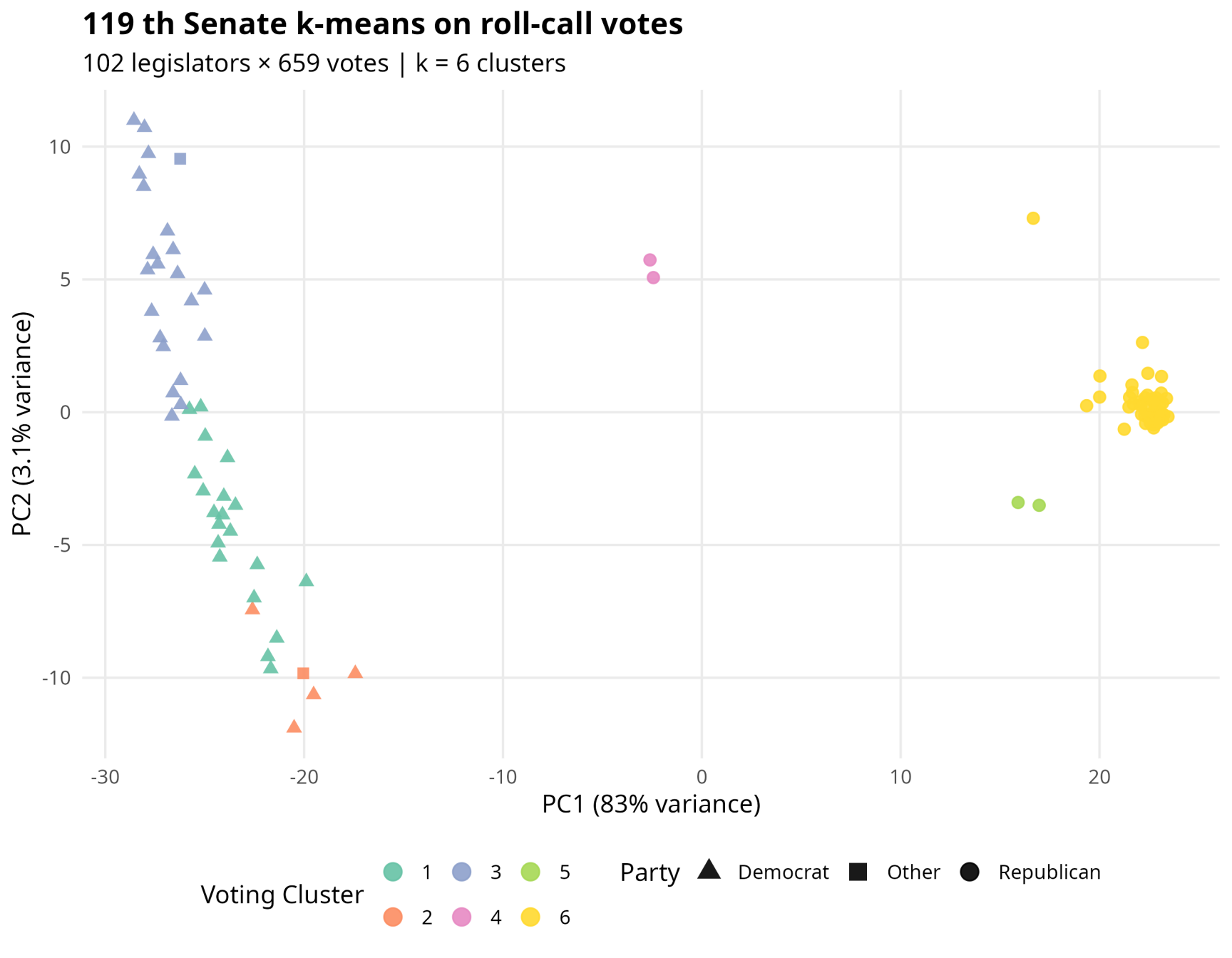
US Senate Extremism

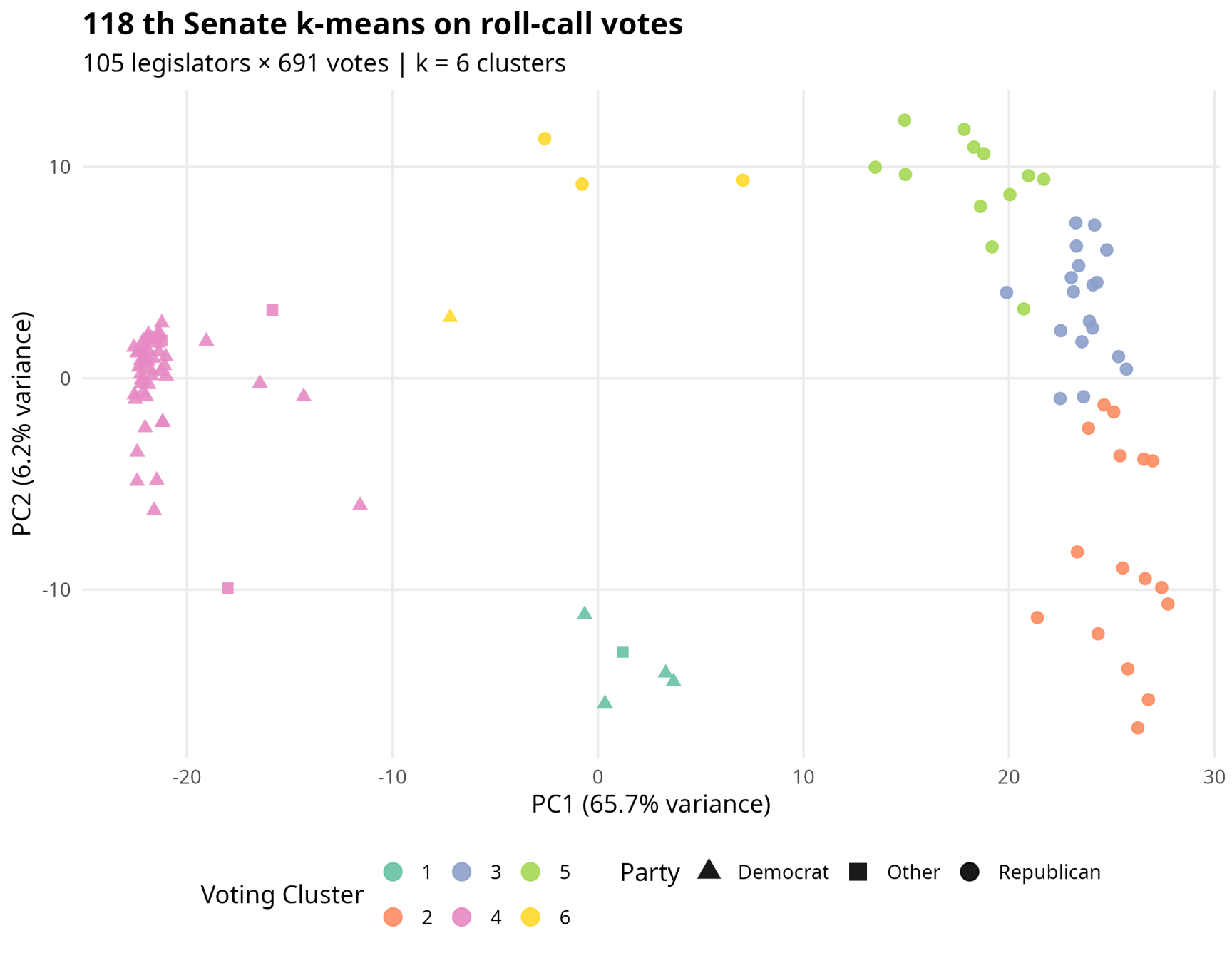
110 - 119 Congresses

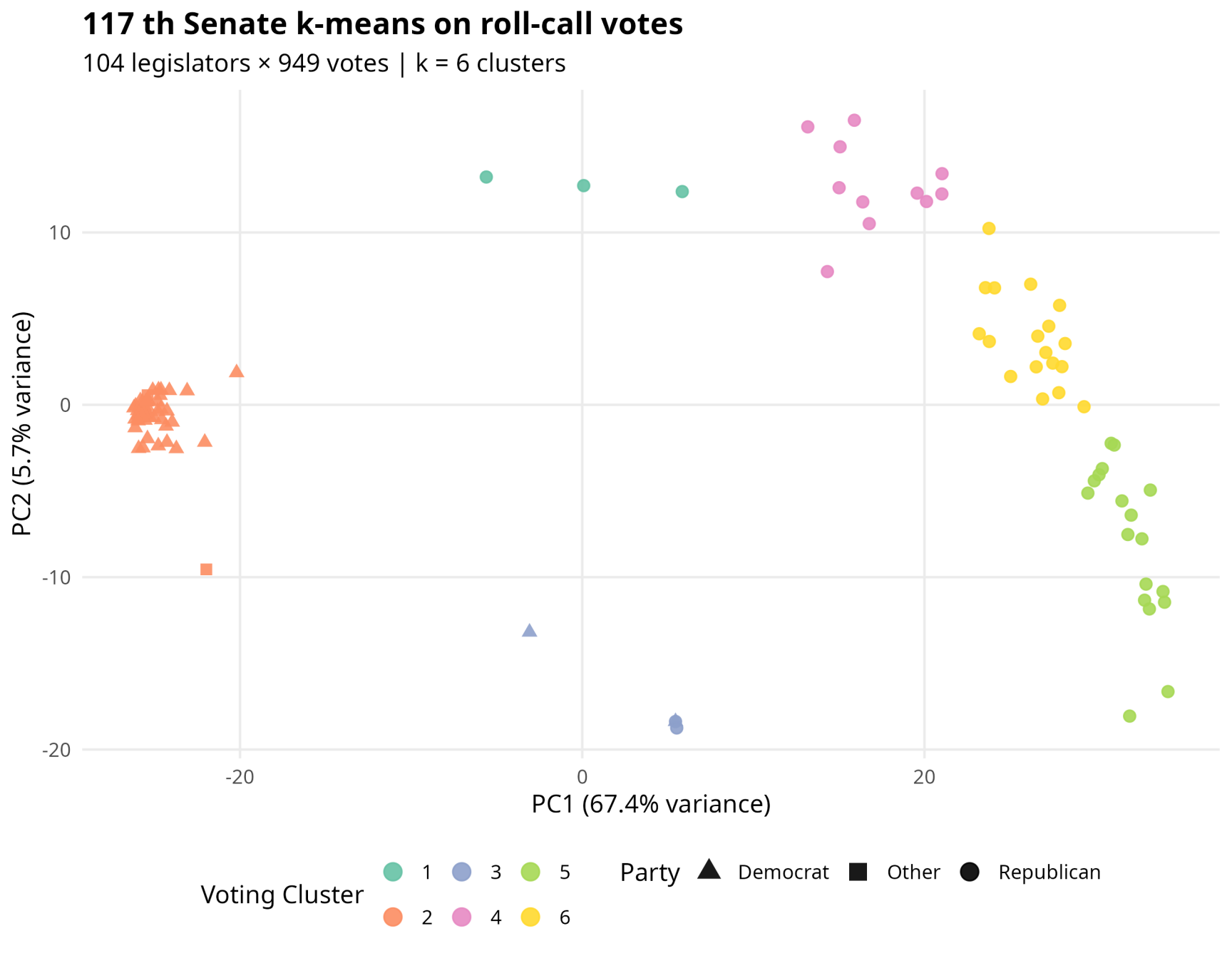
K-Means Cluster of Individual Senators Voting Records

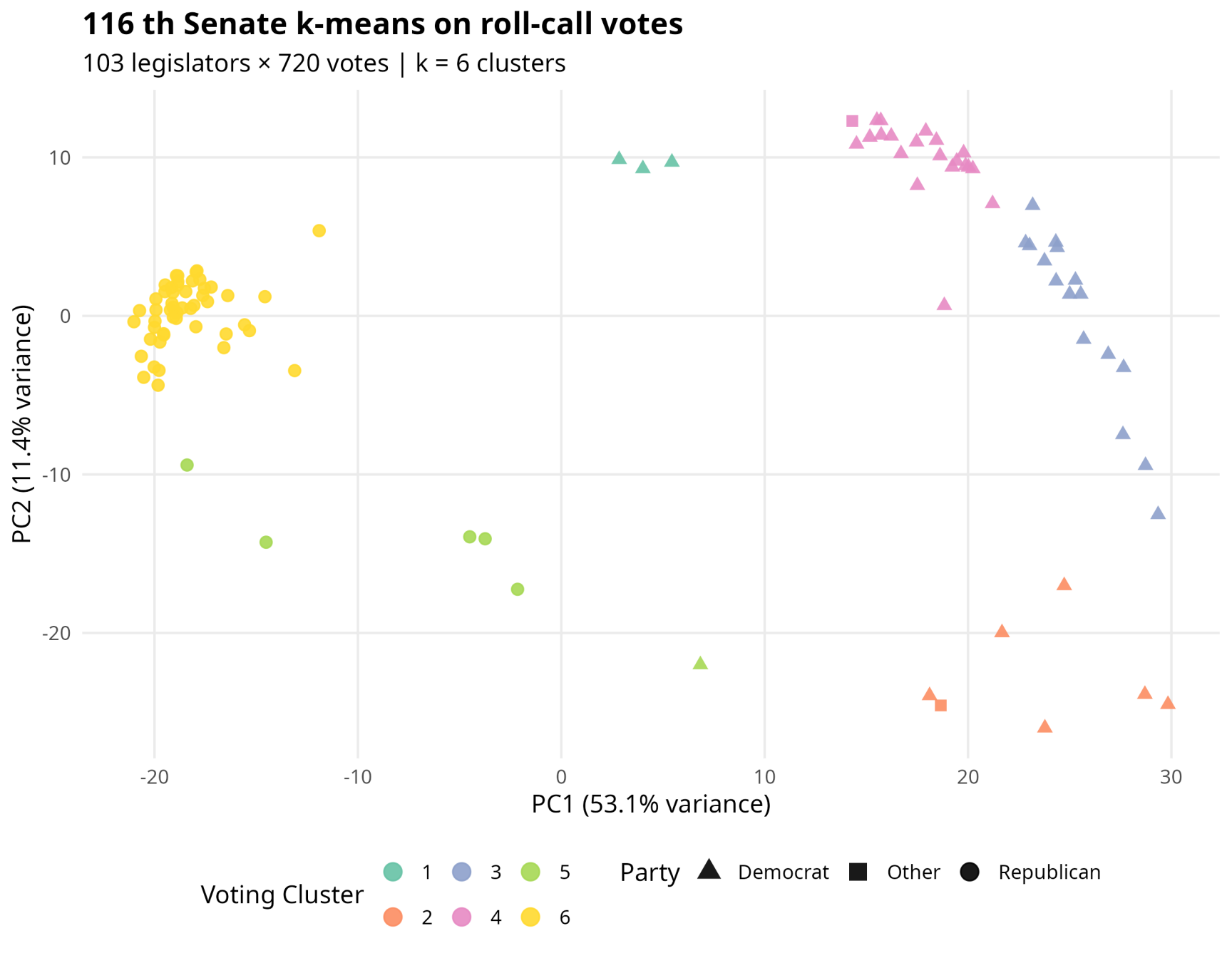
John C. Stevenson
jcs@alumni.caltech.edu

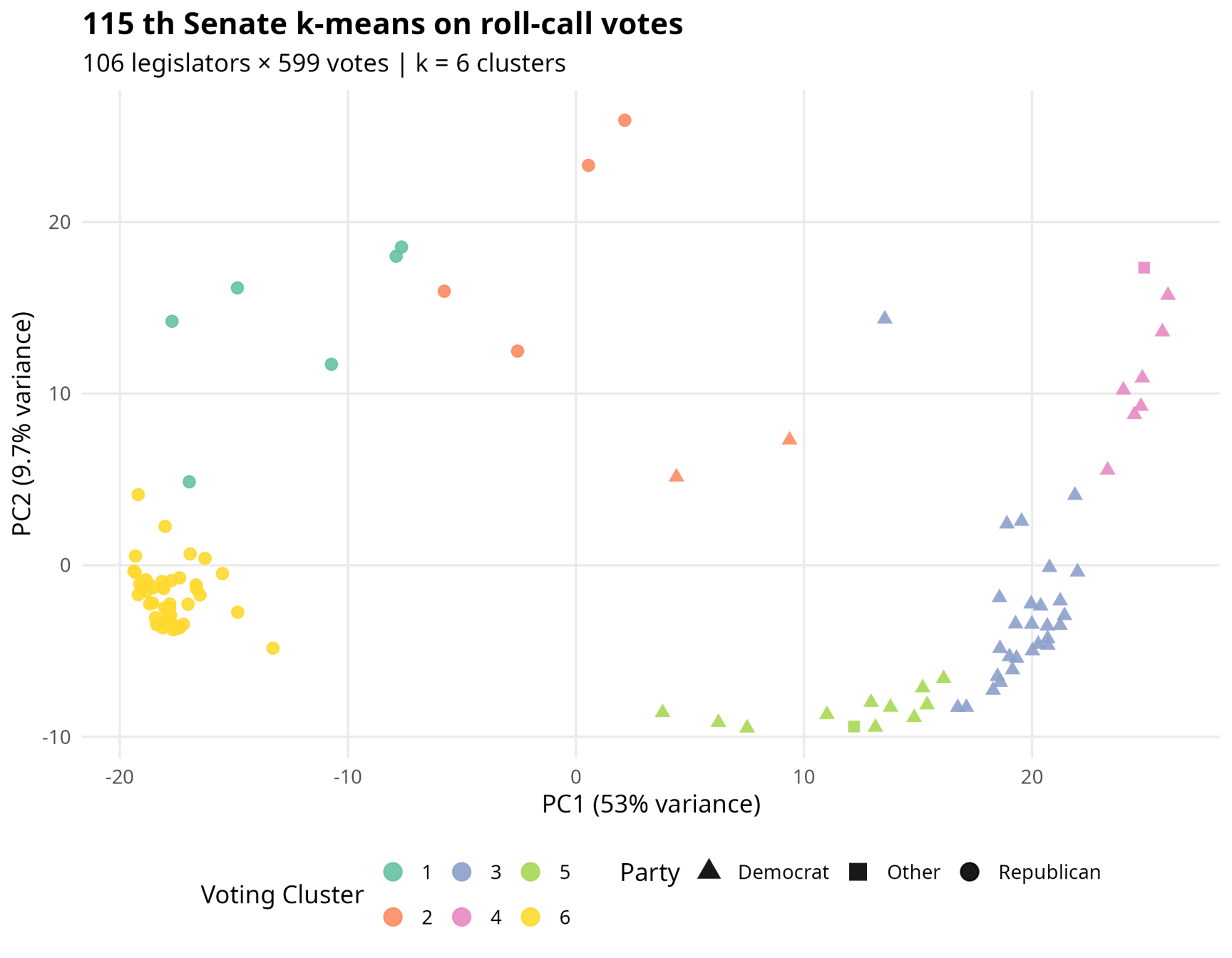
March 5, 2026

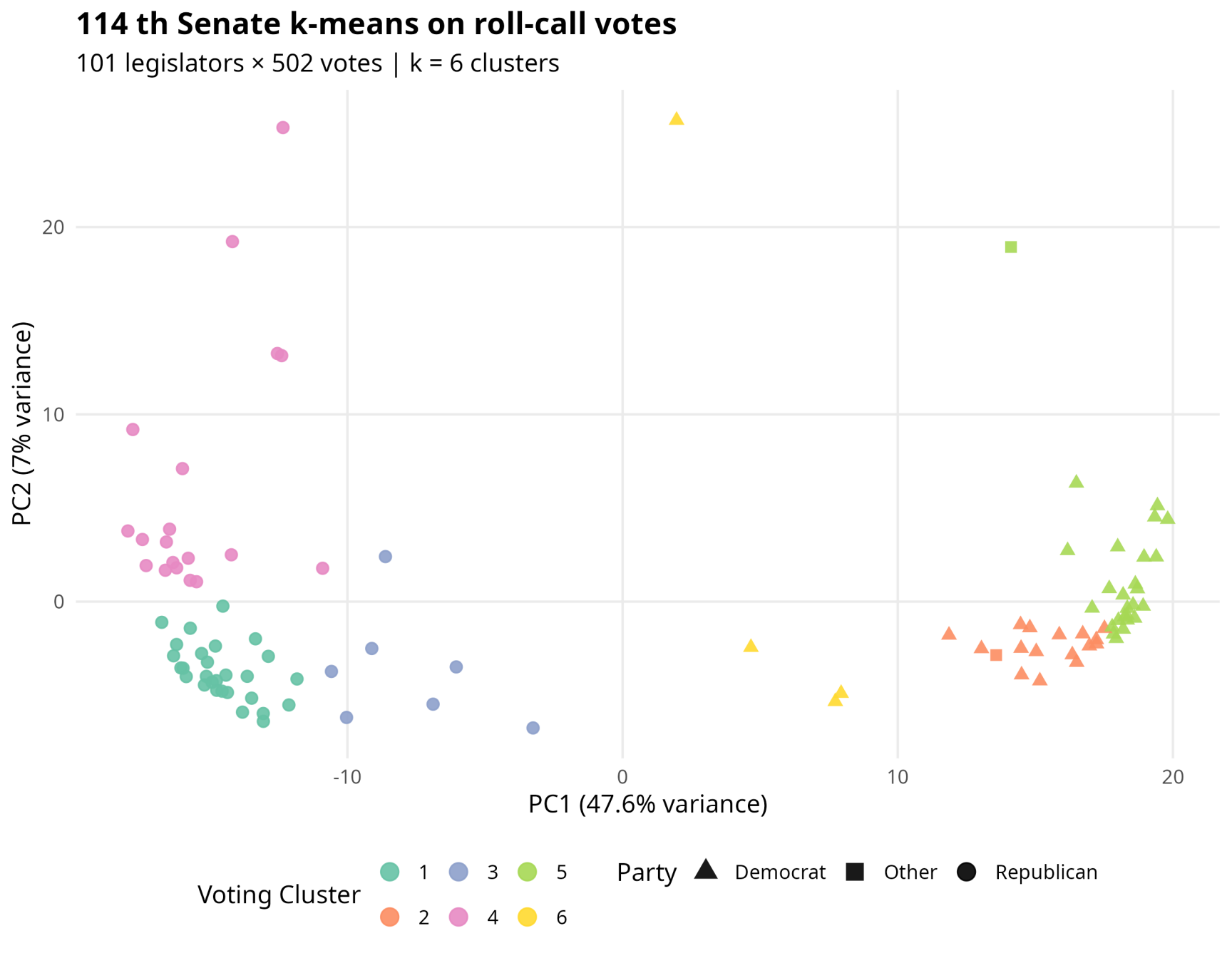

119 th Senate k-means on roll-call votes
102 legislators × 659 votes | k = 6 clusters
PC2 (3.1% variance)
PC1 (83% variance)
10
5
0
-5
-10
-30
-20
-10
0
10
20
Voting Cluster
1
2
3
4
5
6
Party
Democrat
Other
Republican

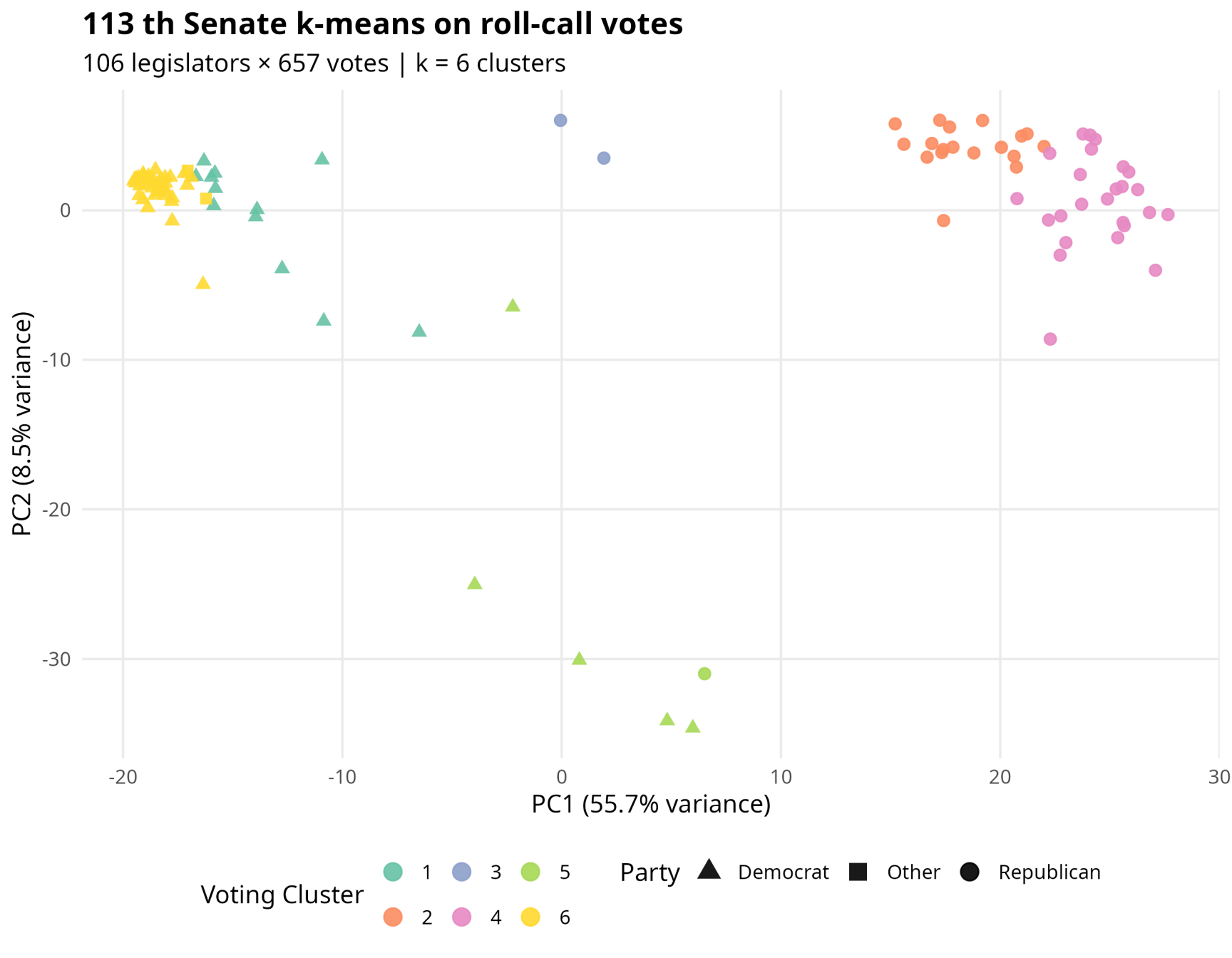

118 th Senate k-means on roll-call votes
105 legislators × 691 votes | k = 6 clusters
PC2 (6.2% variance)
10
0
-10
-20
-10
0
10
20
30
PC1 (65.7% variance)
Voting Cluster
1
3
5
2
4
6
Party
Democrat
Other
Republican

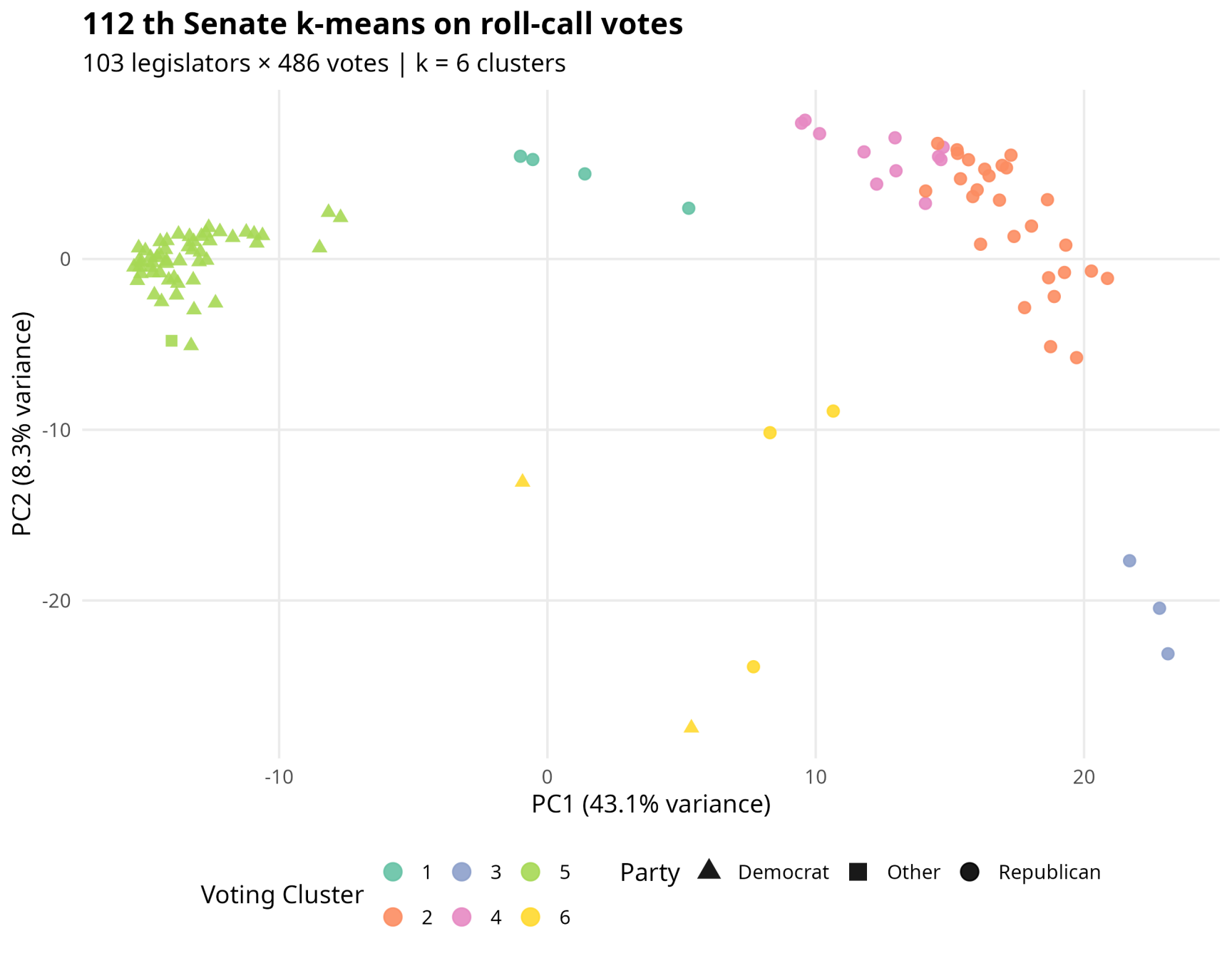

117 th Senate k-means on roll-call votes
104 legislators × 949 votes | k = 6 clusters
PC2 (5.7% variance)
10
0
-10
-20
-20
0
20
PC1 (67.4% variance)
Voting Cluster
1
2
3
4
5
6
Party
Democrat
Other
Republican

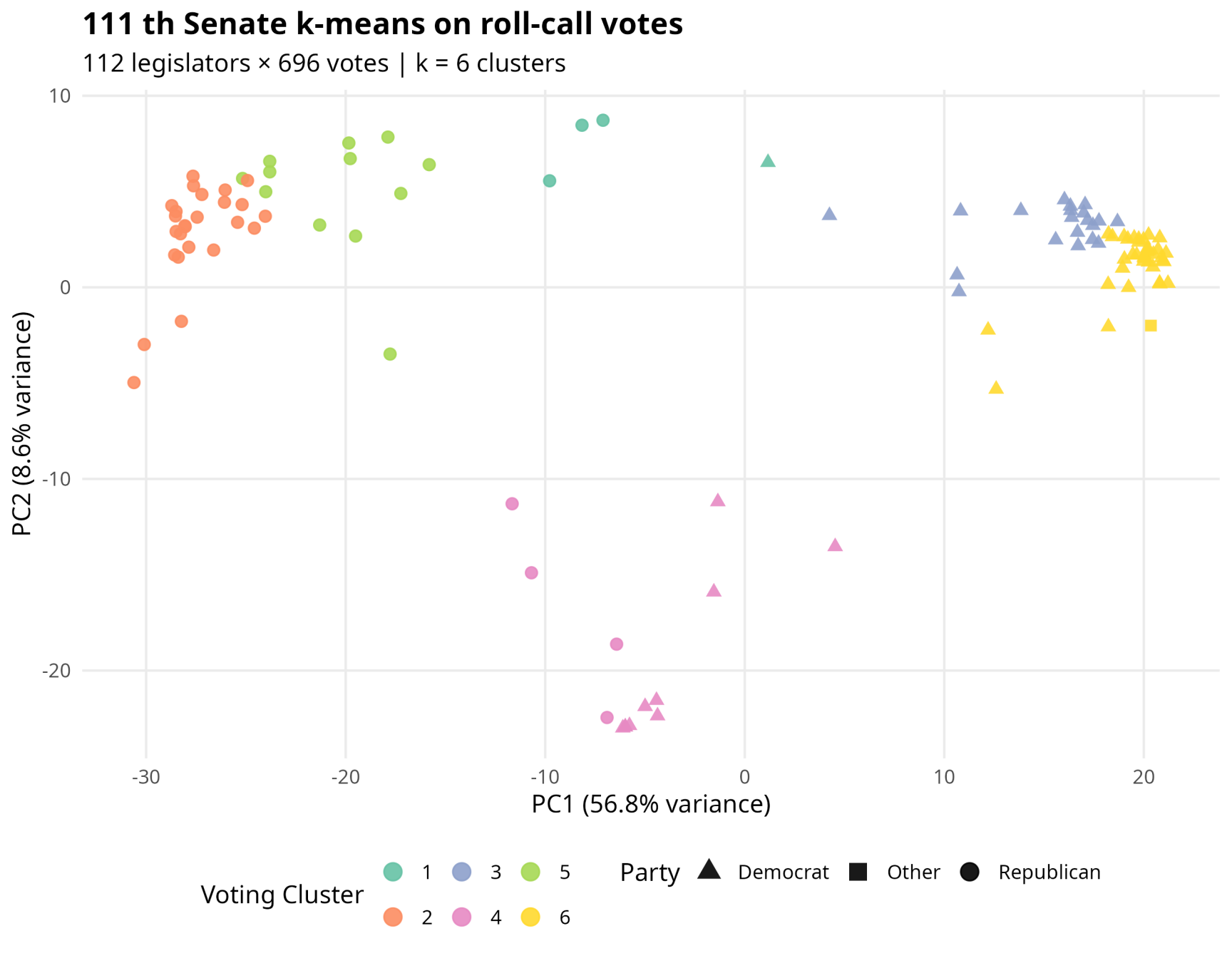

116 th Senate k-means on roll-call votes
103 legislators × 720 votes | k = 6 clusters
PC2 (11.4% variance)
PC1 (53.1% variance)
10
0
-10
-20
-20
-10
0
10
20
30
Voting Cluster
1
2
3
4
5
6
Party
Democrat
Other
Republican

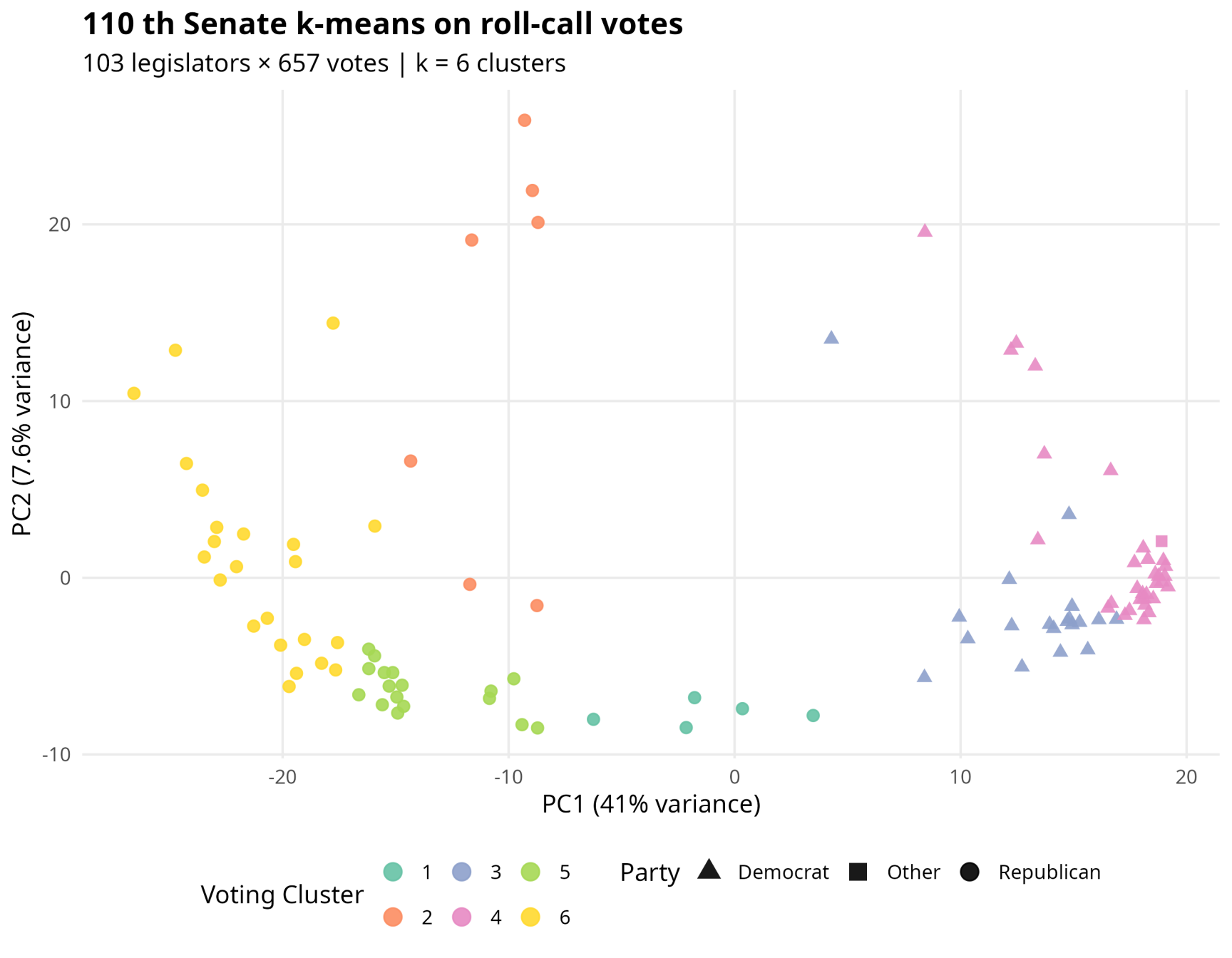

115 th Senate k-means on roll-call votes
106 legislators × 599 votes | k = 6 clusters
PC2 (9.7% variance)
PC1 (53% variance)
20
10
0
-10
-20
-10
0
10
20
Voting Cluster
1
2
3
4
5
6
Party
Democrat
Other
Republican


114 th Senate k-means on roll-call votes
101 legislators × 502 votes | k = 6 clusters
PC2 (7% variance)
20
10
0
-10
0
10
20
PC1 (47.6% variance)
Voting Cluster
1
2
3
4
5
6
Party
Democrat
Other
Republican


113 th Senate k-means on roll-call votes
106 legislators × 657 votes | k = 6 clusters
PC2 (8.5% variance)
0
-10
-20
-30
-20
-10
0
10
20
30
PC1 (55.7% variance)
Voting Cluster
1
2
3
4
5
6
Party
Democrat
Other
Republican


112 th Senate k-means on roll-call votes
103 legislators × 486 votes | k = 6 clusters
PC2 (8.3% variance)
0
-10
-20
-10
0
10
20
PC1 (43.1% variance)
Voting Cluster
1
2
3
4
5
6
Party
Democrat
Other
Republican


111 th Senate k-means on roll-call votes
112 legislators × 696 votes | k = 6 clusters
10
0
-10
-20
PC2 (8.6% variance)
-30
-20
-10
0
10
20
PC1 (56.8% variance)
Voting Cluster
1
2
3
4
5
6
Party
Democrat
Other
Republican


110 th Senate k-means on roll-call votes
103 legislators × 657 votes | k = 6 clusters
PC2 (7.6% variance)
PC1 (41% variance)
20
10
0
-10
-20
-10
0
10
20
Voting Cluster
1
2
3
4
5
6
Party
Democrat
Other
Republican